Write the brief around a decision

A working agreement for evidence, constraints and approval.

01	State the decision the work should help make.	02	Record the evidence and the competing explanation.
03	Give the designer the rules and the unknowns.	04	Put the omissions in the agreement.
05	Agree access and approval.	06	Define a useful handoff.

State the decision the work should help make.

Hypothetical brief: decide how a customer can compare plans before reaching checkout.

A deliverable such as redesign pricing is useful only after the difficult decision is clear.

Customer task

What should the customer understand or finish?

Current obstruction

Which part of the task is difficult today?

Record the evidence and the competing explanation.

Keep a customer observation separate from the founder's diagnosis so the work can test both.

Observed evidence

What happened during the task?

Current explanation

Why do we think it happened?

Alternative to inspect

What else could explain the same behaviour?

Give the designer the rules and the unknowns.

Keep settled decisions separate from assumptions. Otherwise exploration can accidentally reopen a constraint or harden an untested belief.

Type	Example	How to use it
Settled rule	Plan limits are approved.	Treat as a constraint unless an owner changes it.
Assumption	Customers choose mainly by export needs.	Find evidence before prioritising it.
Dependency	Legal wording is still under review.	Name the owner and review point.

Put the omissions in the agreement.

Example boundary: review comparison and checkout information. Do not revise the pricing policy in this work.

Included work

Which part of the task will we examine?

Deliberate omission

What related work is excluded, and why?

Reason to change scope

What evidence would require another discussion?

Agree access and approval.

Customer access, product data and decision ownership determine what the designer can responsibly conclude.

Evidence and access

Which task recordings, customer conversations or product data are available?

Decision owner

Who approves the choice? Who advises or constrains it?

Review point

When will the team inspect the evidence and make the decision?

Define a useful handoff.

State what the team needs to understand and use after the work. A file alone may not carry the rules behind the decision.

Decision record

What choice and reasoning should travel with the work?

Rules and edge cases

Which conditions must the implementation preserve?

Review after release

Who will inspect the task once the change is in use?